University of Roehampton London

ASSESSMENT BRIEF

Programme	BSc (Hons) Psychology		
Module Title	Cognitive and Biological Psychology		
Module Code	PSY020N201A		
Contact for queries about this assessment	*Dr. Sarah Jenkins (s.jenkins@roehampton.ac.uk)*		
Assessment Type(s)	Research Report	**Word Length / Duration**	2,000 words
Deadline (date & time) for Submission	16/05/2027	**% contribution to module mark**	50%
Assessment Feedback date:	07/06/2027	**Format/Location of submission**	Turnitin via Module Moodle page

Assessment Task Requirements

Details of the Assessment Task

You are required to write an empirical research report based on a provided dataset investigating the effects of sleep deprivation on working memory performance in young adults. Your report must critically evaluate relevant psychological literature, analyze the provided experimental data using appropriate statistical techniques, interpret the findings, and discuss their theoretical and practical implications.

Assessment Medium

Written academic report structured in standard empirical journal article format.

Essential Elements

- Formulate clear hypotheses grounded in cognitive psychology theories.
- Analyse the provided dataset using SPSS (or R) to conduct paired-samples t-tests.
- Present descriptive and inferential statistics in APA standard format.
- Ensure strict adherence to British Psychological Society (BPS) ethical guidelines in your discussion.

Submission Links & Guidance

- Submit your document via the **Turnitin Submission Portal** on the PSY020N201A Moodle page.
- Access SPSS Data Analysis Tutorials and Guidance.

Assessment Success Guidance

Key Tips for Success

1. **Clear Theoretical Grounding:** Integrate contemporary theoretical models (e.g., Baddeley's Working Memory Model) into your Introduction.
2. **Accurate Data Reporting:** Present statistical tests fully, including test statistics, degrees of freedom, p-values, and effect sizes (Cohen's d).
3. **Critical Synthesis:** Avoid purely descriptive writing; critically evaluate methodology and conflicting findings in existing research.
4. **Methodological Rigor:** Clearly detail the design, participant demographics, apparatus, and step-by-step procedures in the Method section.
5. **Clear Formatting:** Ensure all figures and tables follow APA 7th edition formatting with proper captions and annotations.

Resources & Exemplars

- Exemplar student reports from previous cohorts are accessible on the Module Moodle Assessment Page.

Layout and Style guidance

Layout Requirements

Your report must follow standard empirical psychology sections:

- **Title Page** (Title, Student ID, Word Count)
- **Abstract** (150–200 words)
- **Introduction** (~600 words)
- **Method** (~400 words: Participants, Materials/Apparatus, Procedure, Design)
- **Results** (~300 words: Tables/Figures and inferential tests)
- **Discussion** (~700 words)
- **References**
- **Appendices** (SPSS output syntax)

Formatting Expectations

- **Font:** Arial or Calibri, 12pt

- **Spacing:** Double-spaced throughout
- **Margins:** 1 inch (2.54 cm) on all sides
- **File Format:** Microsoft Word (.docx) or PDF

Referencing

This module strictly requires **APA 7th Edition** referencing.

- *In-text example:* "Sleep restriction significantly impairs spatial working memory tasks (Smith & Jones, 2023, p. 45)."
- *Reference list example:* Smith, J. A., & Jones, R. B. (2023). Cognitive decline following sleep loss. *Journal of Experimental Psychology*, 15(2), 112–125. https://doi.org/10.1037/xge0001021

Consult the Roehampton Library Cite Them Right Guide for full formatting details.

AI Referencing

If Generative AI tools (e.g., ChatGPT) are used for preliminary brainstorming or proofreading, you must include an **AI Declaration Form** at the end of your submission detailing the prompt, tool name, date, and output used.

Learning Outcomes

By successfully completing this assessment, you will be able to:

- **LO1:** Demonstrate a comprehensive understanding of core theories in cognitive and biological psychology related to executive functioning.
- **LO2:** Select, execute, and report statistical analyses on quantitative experimental data using appropriate software.
- **LO3:** Critically evaluate empirical evidence and formulate evidence-based conclusions within psychological paradigms.

Employability and Professional Skills

By successfully completing this assessment, you will demonstrate:

- **Data Literacy & Analysis:** Ability to analyze complex quantitative datasets and interpret findings using statistical software.
- **Scientific Communication:** Capability to summarize and present complex technical findings clearly for academic and professional audiences.
- **Critical Thinking:** Skill in identifying methodological limitations and evaluating evidence objectively.

Marking Criteria/Assessment Rubric

Assessment name		**Cognitive Research Report**					
Assessment Criteria and LOs	Weighting if appliable	100 Exemplary	70–79 Excellent	60–69 Very Good	50–59 Good	40–49 Adequate	0–39 Fail
Criterion 1: Introduction & Literature Review (LO1)	25%	Exceptionally insightful synthesis of literature; hypotheses are compellingly justified and logically derived.	Excellent integration of relevant theories; clear rationale and precise hypotheses.	Good understanding of relevant theories; well-stated research aims.	Satisfactory review of basic literature; hypotheses present but lack strong grounding.	Descriptive summary with minimal critical synthesis.	Weak or irrelevant literature review; missing hypotheses.
Criterion 2: Methodology & Ethical Considerations (LO3)	20%	Replicability is flawless; meticulous detail provided for participants, measures, and procedures.	Clear, detailed method section allowing straightforward replication.	Good description of methodology with minor details omitted.	Adequate methodology description; minor ambiguity in procedures.	Barely sufficient detail; key methodological elements missing.	Inaccurate or severely incomplete method section.
Criterion 3: Data Analysis & Results (LO2)	25%	Perfect statistical analysis in flawless APA format; fully accurate tables and figures.	Highly accurate data analysis and reporting in standard APA format.	Correct analysis with minor formatting or reporting errors.	Basic statistical analysis correct; noticeable APA formatting errors.	Errors in statistical interpretation or presentation.	Incorrect analyses or failure to report results.
Criterion 4: Discussion & Critical Synthesis (LO1, LO3)	20%	Exceptional interpretation of results linked to literature;	Strong theoretical evaluation of results; insightful	Good discussion connecting results to literature;	Basic discussion of results; weak links to	Superficial discussion; failure to adequately	Unsubstantiated conclusions or missing discussion.

		nuanced reflection on limitations.	identification of limitations.	sensible limitations noted.	theoretical literature.	interpret key findings.	
Criterion 5: Academic Style, Formatting & APA (LO3)	10%	Professional standard throughout; flawless APA referencing and structural presentation.	Excellent academic writing style with minimal APA errors.	Clear writing style; minor errors in referencing or layout.	Adequate academic tone; inconsistent referencing formatting.	Weak structure; frequent grammatical or referencing errors.	Poor writing quality; widespread errors or missing references.

Use of Artificial Intelligence (AI)

Please see University guidelines here:

https://roehamptonprod.sharepoint.com/sites/portal/information/LTEU/Documents/4a%20AI%20principles%20and%20guidance%20-for%20Senate.docx

- The assessment is designed so that the use of AI during the assessment is possible. You must acknowledge any use of AI and appropriately cite all AI generated outputs. Please make sure you read and understand the assessment guidelines and ask your Module Leader if you have any questions. You can find the guidance on the use of AI here*.

Ethical Requirements

This assessment uses pre-collected, fully anonymized secondary datasets. All original data collection complied with the British Psychological Society (BPS) Code of Human Research Ethics. Students must ensure that no attempt is made to re-identify participants.

Submission Checklist

Before you submit, check:

- Have I fully answered the assessment task requirements?
- Is my work within the 2,000-word count limit (+/- 10%)?
- Is my reference list correctly formatted using APA 7th edition style?
- Have I completed and attached an AI declaration form if AI tools were used?
- Have I proofread the text for grammatical accuracy and clarity?
- Am I submitting the correct file (.docx or .pdf) to Turnitin prior to the deadline?

Additional Information

Mitigating circumstances/late penalties

Sometimes circumstances outside of your control may affect your studies and might prevent you from submitting work on time or attending an exam. To avoid late submission penalties, look at our options on the mitigating circumstances portal.

Please speak to your Personal Tutor, the Roehampton Student Union (RSU) or someone in the Wellbeing team first, who can support you.

Resubmissions and Reassessment

If you are required to resubmit this assessment or take part in reassessment, you will be notified via Moodle and your student email. Please ensure you check both regularly. Any reassessment tasks will follow the same learning outcomes and criteria.